

1 (a) $g = GM/R^2$ C1
 $= (6.67 \times 10^{-11} \times 6.4 \times 10^{23}) / (3.4 \times 10^6)^2 = 3.7 \text{ N kg}^{-1}$ A1 [2]

(b) $\Delta E_p = mg\Delta h$
 because $\Delta h \ll R$ (or $1800 \text{ m} \ll 3.4 \times 10^6 \text{ m}$) g is constant B1
 $\Delta E_p = 2.4 \times 3.7 \times 1800$ C1
 $= 1.6 \times 10^4 \text{ J}$ A1 [3]
(use of $g = 9.8 \text{ m s}^{-2}$ max. 1 for explanation)

(c) gravitational potential energy $= (-)GMm/x$ C1
 $v^2 = 2GM/x$ C1
 $x = 4D = 4 \times 6.8 \times 10^6$ C1

$v^2 = (2 \times 6.67 \times 10^{-11} \times 6.4 \times 10^{23}) / (4 \times 6.8 \times 10^6)$
 $= 3.14 \times 10^6$
 $v = 1.8 \times 10^3 \text{ m s}^{-1}$ A1 [4]
(use of 3.5D giving $1.9 \times 10^3 \text{ m s}^{-1}$, allow max. 3)